



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 37

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Fire Extinguisher Use: The PASS Technique

OVERVIEW:

A fire extinguisher only works if the operator knows how to use it correctly and chooses the right type of extinguisher for the class of fire. In a fire emergency, the window for effective extinguisher use is extremely short — typically less than 30 seconds before a small fire grows beyond extinguisher

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. There are four classes of fire. Class A fires involve ordinary combustibles — wood, paper, fabric. Class B fires involve flammable liquids — gasoline, lacquer, solvents. Class C fires involve energized electrical equipment. Class D involves combustible metals. Most construction sites use ABC dry-chemical extinguishers, which are effective on Class A, B, and C fires. Never use water on
2. The PASS technique is the universal method for operating a fire extinguisher. P: Pull the pin that locks the operating handle. A: Aim the nozzle at the base of the fire — not at the flames above, which accomplishes nothing. S: Squeeze the handle to discharge the agent. S: Sweep the nozzle from side to side across the base of the fire. Continue sweeping until the fire is out or the
3. A standard 5-pound ABC extinguisher has approximately 8 to 10 seconds of discharge time. That is not long. Practice the PASS steps mentally before you need them so that the motion is automatic under stress. Before using an extinguisher, confirm that you have a clear exit path behind you. If the fire does not go out with one discharge, do not try a second — evacuate immediately.
4. Know the limitations of a fire extinguisher. Extinguishers are designed to control small, contained fires — the size of a wastebasket or smaller. If the fire is already larger than that, or if it is spreading rapidly, or if it is producing heavy smoke, do not attempt to fight it with an extinguisher. Evacuate, pull the nearest fire alarm, and call 911 from outside the building.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Has anyone ever used a fire extinguisher in a real emergency? Walk us through what happened.
- Q2: Let us physically locate and identify every fire extinguisher in our work area right now.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- P — Pull the pin from the handle before anything else
- A — Aim the nozzle at the BASE of the fire, not the flames above
- S — Squeeze the handle firmly to discharge the extinguishing agent
- S — Sweep from side to side at the base of the fire until extinguished
- Never fight a fire larger than a trash can — evacuate and call 911

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 37

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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